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General Comment

As a small business owner, I believe that AI is an incredible tool that could be used to great ends in assisting Americans. AI can predict illnesses like cancer before they manifest and tell people what lifestyle changes they need make to prevent them; AI can scan through coding and make suggestions, spot errors, etc; it can be used as an extra set of “eyes” for copy-editing; and so much more.

My major concerns with AI are as follows:

AI is a great asset and tool to boost productivity, but we need to consider the public cost of completely replacing middle-class jobs with AI. Replacing jobs with AI should be strictly regulated for the same reason that illegal immigrants should not be able to take jobs from hardworking Americans. Our economy relies on the citizens’ ability to live independently and spend frivolously, but citizens cannot do that if their highly specialized positions are being replaced with AI. Even worse, many experienced, intelligent, hard-working Americans have had to settle for getting on welfare and working at Walmart to scrape by because their skilled corporate jobs were replaced with AI, so now the money that those corporations saved is being shouldered by the general population instead.

Second, Any AI models that rely on datasets, data scraping, etc should acknowledge and respect IP/copyright law. This has been the case with AI in the tech industry for decades; any piece of code added to an AI coding model must belong to the company or the company must have a license to use it, otherwise it’s considered theft. Now that AI’s capabilities and usage have expanded beyond tech labs, the same laws need to be expanded to include all AI models, including generative AI. Rights holders should not only be able to choose whether their data is scraped for AI, but should also be able to license their data out to AI models or corporations should they choose. This will help protect the integrity of small businesses and rights holders all over the country.

Third, there must be more comprehensive copyright protections for American copyright holders against big tech and foreign malefactors. This has always been an issue, but in the age of data scraping for AI it’s imperative that all US citizens and copyright holders are protected from anyone who might attempt to steal, profit from, or censor our work. For example, Google should not be allowed to use AI to censor publishers just because the Google executives don’t like them, and companies like Tencent or Hasbro should not be allowed to feed an American creator’s work to an AI in order to copy their style without hiring or paying them. Any company or country that utilizes generative AI but refuses to engage in transparent, paid use of potentially copyrighted content should be treated with impunity. American content is valuable, American labor is valuable, and thus American creators should be protected from theft worldwide.

And lastly, energy consumption is a major issue. Not all AI is inefficient, but most generative AI models use an ungodly amount of energy to run, and we don’t have infinite coal and gas to burn. In order to become a world leader in AI, the USA also needs to invest in more efficient, more prolific energy sources—specifically geothermal and nuclear energy. Geothermal energy plants have nearly twice the capacity factor as coal plants, and geothermal energy itself is convenient because you can access it anywhere. But nuclear energy, at over 90% capacity factor, is going to be the game-changer. Out of all types of power plants, nuclear power plants produce the most energy throughout the year by far. But our enemies have noticed this too; China is rapidly developing nuclear power plants and spending a lot on nuclear energy research, and at this rate they’ll be outpacing our energy outputs by 2030. If we want to beat a world leader in this energy-consuming tech, we cannot let China overtake us in energy production.